

CHAPTER FIVE: RULES

And then the girl lowered her chin and lazily opened her eyes as she turned her head to look towards his hiding-place. He saw they were, indeed, almond-shaped, saw that they glittered silver... as they looked directly into his...

—James Herbert, *Once...*

Changeling is a setting rich with content for wondrous and terrifying stories. **Changeling** is also a game, containing rules so the participants of those stories can take actions with a fair chance of success or failure. The rules are the foundation of the game, and are basic at their core, offering various permutations to allow for, and restrict, actions depending on the events of the story and the abilities of the characters.

The rules in **Changeling** are consistent, even when different characters possess different levels of potential, or tests vary in complexity. Each player rolls the same type of dice. One character may have a better chance than another to succeed at a given task, thereby granting their player more dice to roll or lowering a targeted difficulty, but the rules remain consistent so the Storyteller and players find them manageable, and ultimately a seamless framework for the game.

This chapter covers the basics, such as rolling dice, various types of actions, and examples of rules in practice. More specific, detail-oriented rules can

be found throughout the book. Don't worry about mastering all the permutations at once — learn the basic rules first, and everything else will come naturally.

The Golden Rule

As has been the case in **Changeling** for the last 20 years, rules come second to the stories players create. The rules are what you make of them. They can represent twists of fate that add Glamour and excitement, or more Banal but utilitarian foundations. Fashion **Changeling** into whatever you need it to be. Whether you're running a nearly diceless chronicle of in-character political brinkmanship or a long-running tactical campaign with each player controlling an entire motley of changelings, if the rules in this book interfere, change them. Your only limits are the depth of your creativity and the breadth of your dream.

Where you're inspired to change or disagree with any of the rules published within this book, propose your own rulings in advance of the game. The game is